

Clean Transcript: The 9 AI Businesses and Two Paths to AI Profits

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The Two Paths to AI Profits

If you're not making money with AI yet, you're probably on the wrong path.

And it has nothing to do with which tools you use or how technical you are. It has everything to do with which of the two paths you pick.

There are nine AI businesses that work right now, and they split into two different paths.

I only figured this out by building my own AI app, which now has thousands of paying users, and also growing to nearly 2 million followers across social media with zero employees.

I've seen a freelancer doing \$30,000 a month from seven clients. I've seen a guy doing \$4 million a year from a paid AI community. And I just met someone who vibe coded an app with AI and hit thousands of dollars in monthly recurring revenue.

All are completely different but valid paths.

Path A is for people who never want to cold DM a stranger.

Path B is for people who need income this week.

So I'm going to break it all down. I'm going to tell you which path is which, and then I'm going to recommend which ones you can choose.

There really are two paths you can choose: Path A and Path B.

Path A is for people who never want to do outbound sales. You don't really want to reach out to people and have to sell people cold. Path A is for building an audience.

Path B is for people who want to pick a niche, do cold outreach, whether that is cold emails, cold calls, or cold DMs, and get paid this week.

If you're looking for a fast income opportunity instead of something that builds up over time, Path B is the one you want to choose.

Path A realistically can take 1 to 3 years. In the AI space, AI is very hot right now, so I've seen people explode in as short as 3 months. My journey was similar. It took me about 3 months until I had my first viral hit. From there, everything kept compounding.

But this is a longer path. If you want cash this week or next week, Path B is the one you want to choose.

Neither one is better in my opinion. It just depends on your needs and your personality.

Some people are comfortable meeting people cold and reaching out to people. Other people don't want that rejection from cold outreach. They would rather have people come to them.

By the way, that's me. I do not flourish in outbound sales. I like it when people come to me through inbound marketing.

However, keep in mind that most people who hit \$1 million end up doing both. I'm really just talking about which path you're going to start with. Realistically, you're going to layer in both of them.

1. AI Content Creator

Path number one is becoming an AI content creator.

It's honestly simple. All you have to do is watch tutorials on YouTube. Generally, you don't want to watch tutorials on other social media platforms because short-form tutorials are too short to convey useful information.

I view all my shorts as traffic to my long-form tutorials on YouTube and in my newsletter.

So all you're going to do is pick a topic like Claude, which is very hot right now. Go to YouTube, search for that topic, and follow along with tutorials. That's day one.

On day two, you share what you learned.

That's the cycle.

For example, you learned how to use Claude on your phone using Dispatch, or if you are using Claude Code, you learned how to use remote control. The next day, you share it on social media.

This loop continues until you grow your audience and followers.

The pitch is that once you have even 10,000 followers, you'll start to get sponsorships and collaboration inquiries inbound. It may take you 6 to 12 months, or for some people 1 to 2 years, to hit 10,000 followers.

Generally, the AI space is so hot right now that if you copy other people's viral content, you should be able to hit this in 3 to 6 months.

The shortcut is to go to Instagram or TikTok, search the hashtag Claude, spend 10 minutes watching the viral videos that appear, and copy them word for word, especially the first 10 seconds.

People copy my videos. They copy my prompts. They don't give me credit. They go viral. And I don't care. Copy my videos. Copy other people's videos. But the most important thing is to copy it exactly, especially the first 10 seconds.

People feel weird about copying, which is good because that means you have a moral compass. However, almost every single AI creator I've seen explode did this. This is literally the formula.

You don't even need ChatGPT. Just open TikTok, open Instagram, and search the thing you're learning. It could be Claude. It could be HeyGen. It could be digital twins. Whatever the topic is, copy the existing viral videos that have at least 1 million views.

Copy the title, the hook, and the script. Beyond the first 10 seconds, you can say whatever you want, but limit your video to 45 seconds max.

This framework applies to text and image carousels as well. It doesn't just have to be video.

The general playbook for people just starting out is to copy what already works. Over time, you will develop your own taste and voice and what you like to post about, and you'll copy less.

The monetization path is sponsorships and collaborations. The reason this works is that there is a lot of money going into AI right now. You have startups and companies flush with hundreds of millions of dollars in funding, and they are looking to buy creators and sponsor videos.

Once you hit the minimum floor of at least 10,000 followers across platforms, you can start getting sponsorship and collaboration deals.

2. Repurposing as a Service

AI business number two is repurposing as a service.

This is related to number one. If you do number one first and then offer number two, you'll be in an even stronger position.

Repurposing means taking one piece of content and turning it into many pieces of content for other platforms.

When I first started, I did one LinkedIn post a day. Eventually, I got the bandwidth to do a couple TikTok posts per day. But those were only two platforms. What about Instagram? Facebook? Twitter? Substack? Pinterest?

The pitch here is that you DM a creator and say:

I want to help you grow. You don't have to do anything. I'm going to take your existing content and grow you on other platforms.

For example, if somebody makes long-form YouTube tutorials, you can cut those into shorts and grow them on TikTok, Instagram, and Threads.

This works because content creators are not system builders. They're not AI people for the most part. Only a small portion of content creators know about AI, building systems, automation, or anything like that.

You have an entire universe of creators who don't know how to do that, but they all want to grow.

If your pitch to a creator is, "I'm going to help you grow hands-free on autopilot. You don't have to do anything, and I'm going to manage it across multiple platforms," that is a winning pitch.

People make the mistake of pitching individual tasks, like video editing. That's nice, but it's not high leverage.

People want the outcome. The outcome you're delivering here is followers with zero additional effort. That is the pitch. That's why it's compelling.

You don't want to pitch individual tasks like editing, ManyChat automation, or setting up a website. Those are tasks. The closer you can get to promising and delivering the outcome creators want, the more valuable your pitch becomes.

You have a unique advantage if you know about AI, systems, and automation. Most creators are not in AI. They don't know you can take one type of content, repurpose it with AI into another type of content, and then post it automatically on social media.

You can set up those systems and charge a monthly retainer to keep an eye on them and make sure they stay up to date.

Path A takes longer to build up. It's not necessarily the fastest cash, but content creation and repurposing are valuable foundational skills.

3. Faceless YouTube Channels

Number three is faceless channels.

There is a lot of misunderstanding around how faceless channels make money.

There are generally two monetization paths.

One is getting paid by the platform based on the number of views, audience demographics, and watch time. This is called platform rewards.

The second way is to use AI to replicate viral faceless formats and drive people to an offer. That offer could be a mobile app, a digital product, an info product, something in your link tree, or coaching.

Both paths can work. However, most content you see about faceless channels focuses on platform rewards.

Platform rewards can make money. YouTube channels like ASMR, bedtime music, or edutainment-style faceless documentaries can make thousands per month. It is possible to make \$50,000 per month with platform rewards.

However, there is really only one platform where that is possible: YouTube long-form video. Not Shorts.

You do not get paid that much for YouTube Shorts, Instagram Reels, Facebook videos, or TikTok.

If you're seeing content around making faceless videos, keep in mind that platform rewards require YouTube long-form video.

Also, the truly successful channels monetizing this way are not automated. Just because something uses AI does not mean it was automated.

If you want to pursue this path, use YouTube long-form and do not automate it fully. You can still use AI to generate images, generate video clips, help with editing, brainstorm titles, do competitive research, create thumbnails, and create SEO descriptions. You can use AI at every step, but don't fully automate the channel.

The beginner mistake is thinking you can put in a prompt, let it run, and hope it works. It doesn't work like that.

The most successful faceless channels making at least \$10,000 to \$20,000 a month usually copy other channels. They research niches where there are YouTube channels with a low number of subscribers but a high number of views, and then they copy that format.

A recurring trend in content creation is that people are not that original at the beginning. We copy other people. Over time, we develop taste, preferences, and a unique brand.

Faceless can be powerful, but there are misleading claims around income.

Driving traffic to your own offer can make more money than relying on platform rewards. With short-form platforms like TikTok, Reels, and YouTube Shorts, you can go viral and drive people to an offer that is not based on views.

For example, a mobile app can post slideshows with tips on how to go viral on TikTok, drive traffic back to the app, and generate thousands in monthly recurring revenue.

The key is to use short-form algorithms for growth and drive people to a paid offer outside of platform rewards.

4. AI Education Communities

Number four is education communities.

This also takes a long time to build up. The most successful communities are usually started by founders who first built a massive brand and following.

A common mistake is launching a community and assuming people will join. Nobody knows who you are. You have no credibility. Random internet strangers need a reason to join.

There are many AI communities making at least \$50,000 per month. Some are focused on learning AI. Some are focused on AI automation. Some are about making money with AI, including how to pitch, sell services, and choose offers. Some focus on creative use cases, AI image tools, advanced video, or vibe coding.

There are also communities targeting specific demographics, such as women in AI or Gen X.

Communities are powerful because they create recurring revenue.

In the traditional info product space, you might sell a course, cohort, or workshop one time. A community can include all of those, but it also includes people.

People are premium. People are willing to pay to be in a space with other talented people.

A strong community offer includes:

- A course.

- A cohort of people learning alongside each other.
- Weekly workshops, meetings, builds, and Q&A sessions.
- Access to talented people who are actually winning.

The most valuable posts in any community are wins. Someone sharing that they closed a \$10,000 contract, hit a revenue milestone, or booked speaking gigs makes the community more valuable.

Content can be copied. People and their wins are harder to replicate.

The funnel for communities is simple. It starts with content. The main platforms are YouTube long-form and Instagram. Instagram and Facebook work well because of DM automations.

The top of funnel is YouTube videos and Instagram videos. Those drive people into the paid community.

For example, you can show a complicated AI automation and say people can build it themselves or join the community for \$70 per month and download the template.

That can scale to \$50,000 per month without a large team, though you may want to hire a couple people for your sanity.

5. Personal AI Assistant for Founders

Now we move to Path B.

Everything in Path A works, but it can take 1 to 3 years to compound. If you need income right now, Path B is faster.

Number five is building a personal AI assistant for busy founders.

Imagine a busy, stressed-out founder. Maybe a solo founder. Maybe they have a tiny team. They are drowning in work every day.

Most founders are non-technical. They are not building systems or automations actively. They have heard about AI, but they don't know where to start.

The opportunity is to build an AI assistant that takes 10 to 15 hours of work off their plate every week.

For example, you could build an AI assistant that scans their email every morning and surfaces the most urgent items. It could look through CRM data and follow up with stale leads or leads at risk. It could build internal dashboards so the founder knows what is happening in sales, support, or social media analytics.

These things are valuable to a busy founder.

Most founders need help with sales, support, marketing, admin, recruiting, HR, filtering candidates, and productivity.

The offer is to build an AI assistant, second brain, or operating system that actually does things. It should not just tell the founder what to do.

It should write emails. It should proactively reach out to stale leads. It should take action.

A good starting point is email and CRM.

The offer is not just the tool. The offer is setting it up, maintaining it monthly, and continuing to build on top of it.

To get your first five customers, cold DM people on Instagram and LinkedIn.

Instagram is where many founders are active. LinkedIn still has decision makers, but many people spend more time on Instagram.

To find busy founders, look at comment sections. Find viral videos about productivity AI tools. Look at the people who commented to get the guide or playbook. Those people already raised their hand and showed interest.

Most of them will not implement the tutorial because they don't have time.

Busy founders like to throw money at problems. They would rather have someone DM them and say, "I'll do everything for you. Just pay me this."

When pitching founders or executives, keep this in mind: do it for them and charge more.

The pitch is simple:

I will build you an AI assistant that saves you 15+ hours per week.

Start with a small subset of things you are confident you can automate or streamline. Email is a good place to start. Social media dashboards are another simple starting point. Founders often have little visibility into what is actually working.

6. Claude Training for Businesses

Number six is Claude training for businesses.

Claude is one of the hottest AI tools to learn right now. There are tutorials on YouTube, but not as many as you would think. There are many use cases that are not addressed.

For example, how do you use Claude as a team? How do you roll it out at a mid-sized or large company? How do marketing teams, finance teams, founders, CFOs, and accountants use it?

Everybody wants to learn Claude, whether they are SMBs, mid-large companies, solo founders, or teams.

The offer is Claude training for business teams.

You can package it many ways:

- Claude training for teams.
- Claude Code training for teams.
- Claude training for marketing teams.
- Claude training for busy founders.
- Claude training for finance teams.
- Claude training for accountants.

The pitch is:

I will train your team how to use Claude in one day, and you will save five hours per week per person.

You can charge \$10,000 to \$40,000 for this type of training, depending on the business and scope.

For services, training, and consulting, charge the highest number you can say out loud without laughing.

Companies have money. They often don't know what to spend it on. AI training and upskilling employees is a strong use of funds.

To get your first five customers, use cold DMs on LinkedIn and Instagram. Find viral Claude videos, look at who is commenting, and DM those people.

For example:

Hey, I saw you were interested in setting up Claude and Remotion to make unlimited videos. I teach teams how to do that. Would your team be interested?

Some percentage of people want someone to do it for them or hold their hand through it.

Another way to get customers is to be a guest on a large podcast or YouTube channel that covers Claude training.

DM YouTubers who cover Claude and say:

I made a unique Claude workflow that does this. Would you like me to show it to your audience for free?

YouTubers like this because it gives them extra content with little extra work. You benefit because people watching the video may want you to roll it out for their team.

Cold DMs work, but volume matters. Don't DM five people per day. DM up to 200 people per day. Spend 4 hours doing it. After a week of serious volume, you can get clients.

7. AI Consulting and Audits

Number seven is AI consulting and audits.

There is overlap between Claude training and consulting, but Claude training is a specific offer with high demand right now.

AI consulting can include strategy, audits, process gaps, tool selection, implementation roadmaps, automation plans, and training.

Usually, you start with an audit. Until you understand what a company does, which tools they use, how their processes work, and how teams collaborate, it is hard to recommend tools or build a roadmap.

Most businesses are at level one out of five in AI fluency and maturity. They installed ChatGPT, typed a few prompts, and that's it.

That is why there is so much opportunity in AI education, training, and consulting. The gap is huge.

The pitch is simple:

I help businesses save 20 hours per week and gain more revenue through AI tools. Let me audit your business and show you where AI can save you time and money.

Some people do audits for free when they are starting out. Paid audits can range from \$500 to \$15,000, depending on the business, complexity, and whose attention you have.

To get clients, use cold DMs on LinkedIn and Instagram.

The cold DM should not sound like generic AI text. The bar is low. Respond like a human. Share a relevant work sample if possible.

Most people fail at cold DMs because they don't do enough volume. Ten messages per day is not enough. Set aside 4 hours and DM people.

The pitch can also include the fear of falling behind:

I'll audit your business, show you where to save time and money, and help make sure you don't fall behind your competitors.

8. AI Automation Agency

Number eight is an AI automation agency.

An AI automation agency helps businesses connect their tools and streamline their processes.

The basic pitch is:

You have a bunch of disconnected tools in your business. I'm going to help connect them and streamline your processes so you save time and make more money.

Before AI automation agencies, there were automation agencies. Those agencies used tools like n8n, Make, Zapier, or custom scripts to automate workflows.

AI automation simply means that some steps in the workflow now call AI, such as ChatGPT or another AI model.

People have been building workflow automations for decades. AI just adds a new layer.

To get clients, you can make content, cold DM people, or apply to freelance jobs on Upwork.

However, AI automation agencies are harder than many people make them sound.

Most creators pushing AI automation agencies make more money from their communities and education than from their agencies.

The reason is that this type of agency is hard to scale. You need someone bringing in clients, and you need someone doing fulfillment: building, troubleshooting, debugging, and maintaining automations.

Workflow automations break. There are edge cases. Tools don't always have APIs. Data is messy. Systems don't talk to each other. Businesses rarely have clean documentation.

A typical business is messy from an infrastructure point of view. They have data everywhere, duplicated information, unstructured systems, and manual processes.

That means an AI automation agency involves consulting, auditing, tool selection, roadmapping, implementation, deployment, and maintenance.

You can make money with it. You can build a million-dollar AI automation agency. But it is not as easy as the hype makes it sound.

If you're building an AI automation agency, Upwork can be a good place to start, especially if you're brand new and hungry.

The bar on Upwork is low. Many applications are generic AI-generated responses. To stand out, respond quickly, ideally within 12 hours, write like a human, answer the exact questions in the job post, and avoid long generic proposals.

Speed matters on freelance platforms. A busy founder may post a job and only pay attention for a few hours. You want to be one of the first 10 applicants.

Apply to the newest jobs within the first couple of hours. Don't waste credits applying to old posts.

The pitch is always the same:

I'll build automations that save you time and money.

Don't get distracted by shiny tools. Businesses care about making more money or saving time.

9. Vibe Coding and SaaS Products

Number nine is vibe coding and SaaS products.

Vibe coding means building apps, websites, and products with AI. Traditionally, you had to write code. Now you can describe what you want, and AI can plan it, write code, and show a preview.

For simple MVPs and fast iteration, this is powerful.

However, this is one of the hardest paths. If you're strapped for cash, it is slow. If you don't have an audience, it is slow. If you don't know marketing, it is hard to get users.

The upside is recurring revenue and enterprise value. If you build a technology product with recurring revenue, you may eventually sell it for a multiple of revenue.

For example, if your product makes \$1 million per year, you may be able to sell it for \$5 million to \$20 million, depending on churn, quality, and whether the acquirer can operate it without you.

But getting started is hard. You have to market the product. People often pay low prices for software compared with communities or services. And building a good product is hard.

Vibe coding makes it easy to build fast. It does not make it easy to build something good.

The biggest mistake is making the app too complicated.

The ideal vibe-coded product does one thing really well within the first 90 seconds after someone signs up.

That's it.

Do not make users click 100 times before they reach the aha moment. Keep the MVP focused on one clear outcome.

Another mistake is failing to switch from product building to marketing after launch.

While building, it may be normal to spend 90% of your time on product and 10% on marketing. After launch, that ratio needs to flip. You need to spend 90% of your time on marketing, especially if you don't already have an audience.

If you don't do this, you get a tiny trickle of users, not enough data, and not enough feedback to know what to fix.

Marketing can mean creating content, partnering with creators, influencer marketing, or cold DMs to people who already raised their hand about the pain point.

Cold DM people who commented on posts related to the problem your product solves.

Content doesn't have to show your face. You can use faceless formats that promote apps and products.

You need volume. It is not one post per day and hoping it works. You may need 4 hours a day on marketing until you have a steady stream of users.

Many vibe coders stay stuck because they keep adding features instead of getting users.

If you already have an audience, launching a product is easier because you have an immediate feedback loop. If you don't, you need to partner with someone who can market or spend serious time on marketing yourself.

Vibe coding can be profitable, but it is not the best starting point for someone brand new to AI.

Final Recommendation

All nine businesses can generate revenue. Every single one can scale to \$1 million.

The real decision is which path makes sense for you.

Path A includes:

- AI content creator.
- Repurposing as a service.
- Faceless channels.
- Education communities.

These are slower. They may take 1 to 3 years to build up. They don't require cold outreach or hard selling, but they require consistency and patience.

Path B includes:

- Personal AI assistant for founders.
- Claude training for businesses.
- AI consulting and audits.
- AI automation agency.

These are faster. They can generate cash sooner, but they require direct outreach, sales, and rejection.

For Path B, the main sales process is cold outreach for 4 hours a day on LinkedIn and Instagram.

Number nine, vibe coding and SaaS products, can make a lot of money, but it is hard. It works better if you already have an audience, technical background, or a marketing partner.

If you're brand new, the recommended starting point is content. Content sets you up for everything else.

With a personal brand, you can make money through sponsorships, launch a community, sell Claude training, get consulting clients, or launch a product to an existing audience.

The best path depends on your personality, timeline, and need for cash.

If you can handle the marathon, start with Path A.

If you need money quickly, choose Path B and do serious outreach.